Bow Valley College

# Course Outline

## HCAD1403

Communication & Documentation in the Health Care Environment
Fall 2026 - Current

Last Updated: 4/17/2026 1:27:25 PM

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Bow Valley College is situated in Treaty 7 territory. We honour the territories and Peoples of: the Blackfoot Confederacy, which includes the Siksika, Kainai, Piikani, and Amskapi Piikani (Blackfeet) First Nations; the Tsuut'ina First Nation; and the Îyâxe Nakoda, which includes the Goodstoney, Chiniki, and Bearspaw First Nations. We also acknowledge the historical Northwest Métis homeland and the Otipemisiwak Métis Government of Alberta, districts 4, 5, and 6 in Battle River territory.

# HCAD1403 Communication & Documentation in the Health Care Environment

## COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course will focus on the role and responsibilities of the health care aide when communicating effectively as a member of the collaborative care team. Strong communication skills are an important part of being a successful health care aide. The health-care environment requires competent verbal, written, and electronic communication skills, which are part of digital literacy. This course will focus on professional communication with other team members, clients, and client's families; written communication, including documentation in client records and report completion; problem-solving strategies; and handling conflict successfully. A focus on communicating effectively with clients from all cultures while demonstrating cultural competence and understanding the diversity of individuals will be included. Communication strategies for overcoming the challenges and barriers to communication between the client and caregiver caused by disease, illness, and aging in the client will also be discussed. Bow Valley College is licensed to deliver this course as part of the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum 2019.

| | |
|---|---|
| REQUISITES | None |
| EQUIVALENTS | None |
| CREDITS | 4 |
| HOURS | 60 |
| ELIGIBLE FOR PLAR | Yes |
| ZERO TEXTBOOK COST | No |

## COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Bow Valley College is committed to ensuring our graduates can demonstrate their abilities in key areas that will make them effective citizens and encourage their development as lifelong students. In addition to the discipline-specific skills that students acquire in their programs, the College has identified ten learning outcomes.

**College-Wide Outcomes:**

1. Communication
2. Thinking Skills
3. Numeracy and Financial Literacy
4. Working with Others

5. Digital Literacy
6. Positive Attitudes and Behaviours
7. Continuous Learning
8. Health and Wellness Awareness
9. Citizenship and Intercultural Competence
10. Environmental Sustainability

| # | COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S) | COLLEGE WIDE OUTCOMES SUPPORTED |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Describe principles of communication, including privacy and confidentiality, required for maintaining effective helping and professional relationships. | 1,2,4 |
| 2 | Demonstrate principles of communication that the HCA will use in helping relationships and when working in a collaborative care team to implement the client's care plan. | 1,4 |
| 3 | Analyze own communication style and compare it to effective communication strategies required in the HCA role. | 1,2,7 |
| 4 | Apply effective conflict management strategies in relationships. | 1,4,9 |
| 5 | Demonstrate evidence-informed practice principles of accurate documentation and information technology (electronic records and charting) when applicable. | 2,3,5,10 |
| 6 | Describe the impact that culture and diversity can have on communication. | 3,4,6,8,9 |
| 7 | Demonstrate communication strategies and use resources and tools where available specific to diverse clients of different cultural backgrounds. | 1,2,6,7,9 |
| 8 | Describe various communication strategies to use with clients experiencing communication impairments or who are displaying responsive behaviours. | 1,2,6,9 |
| 9 | Apply communication techniques and strategies that support person-centered care and the collaborative team to a variety of situations/scenarios: clients with communication impairments, displaying responsive behaviours, and confused and/or unconscious clients in palliative care and end-of-life situations. | 1,2,6,7,9 |
| 10 | Demonstrate and practise effective communication strategies use when delivering person-centred care. | 1,2,6,9 |

## COURSE MODULES AND SCHEDULE

**Course schedule subject to change, depending on delivery mode and term of study. For exact dates, please consult the Course Offering Information in Brightspace.*

| WEEK/HOURS | MODULES |
|---|---|
| Week 1 | Module 1: Communication in a Collaborative Team |
| Week 2 | Module 1: Communication in a Collaborative Team/Module 2: Dealing with Problems and Conflict |
| Week 3 | Module 2: Dealing with Problems and Conflict/Module 3: Cultural Competence & Diversity |
| Week 4 | Module 3: Cultural Competence & Diversity |
| Week 5 | Module 4: Documentation |
| Week 6 | Module 4: Documentation |
| Week 7 | Reading Week (dates may vary) |
| Week 8 | Module 5: Communication Impairments and Related Strategies |
| Week 9 | Module 5: Communication Impairments and Related Strategies |
| Week 10 | Module 5: Communication Impairments and Related Strategies |
| Week 11 | Module 5: Communication Impairments and Related Strategies |
| Week 12 | Module 5: Communication Impairments and Related Strategies |
| Week 13 | Module 5: Communication Impairments and Related Strategies |
| Week 14 | Final Exam |

## ASSESSMENT

| COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S) | ASSESSMENT | WEIGHT |
|---|---|---|
| 1-10 | Final Exam | 100% |
| 1-10 | Completion of Lab Skills | Pass/Fail |

Important: For details on each assignment and exam, please see the Course Offering Information.

## PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

A minimum grade of D is required to pass this course. However, a program may require a higher grade in this course to progress in the program or to meet specific program completion requirements.

As per the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum and Licensing Policies, learners are required to achieve a minimum grade of B- (70%) to pass all theory and lab courses, including this course. As well, in courses HCAD1401, HCAD1403, HCAD1404, HCAD1406, and HCAD1407, learners must achieve a "pass" on all lab skills outlined in the Lab Skills Guide.

Please consult with the program area or contact the program chair for further details. A minimum Grade Point Average of 2.0 is required for graduation.

## GRADING SCHEME

| Grade | Percentage | Grade Point | Description |
|---|---|---|---|
| A+ | 95-100 | 4.0 | Exceptional: superior knowledge of subject matter |
| A | 90-94 | 4.0 | Excellent: outstanding knowledge of subject matter |
| A- | 85-89 | 3.67 | |
| B+ | 80-84 | 3.33 | |
| B | 75-79 | 3.0 | Very Good: knowledge of subject matter generally mastered |
| B- | 70-74 | 2.67 | |
| C+ | 67-69 | 2.33 | |
| C | 64-66 | 2.0 | Satisfactory/Acceptable: knowledge of subject matter adequately mastered |
| C- | 60-63 | 1.67 | |
| D+ | 57-59 | 1.33 | |
| D | 50-56 | 1.0 | Minimal Pass |
| F | Less than 50 | 0.0 | Fail: an unsatisfactory performance |

## REQUIRED LEARNING RESOURCES

*Government of Alberta. (2019). Health care aide provincial curriculum learner guide: Course 3 communication and documentation in the health-care environment. Edmonton, AB.*

*(A digital copy is available in Brightspace, or a printed copy can be purchased at the bookstore.)*

*Government of Alberta. (2019). Health care aide provincial curriculum lab skills guide courses 1, 3, 4, 6 and 7. Edmonton, AB.*

*(A digital copy is available in Brightspace, or a printed copy can be purchased at the bookstore.)*

Sorrentino, S., Remmert, L., Wilk, M., Newmaster, R. (2021). Sorrentino's Canadian Textbook for the Support Worker– Text, Workbook and Clinical Skills: Skills for Nurse Assisting. (5th Canadian ed.) Toronto: Elsevier Canada or current edition. (ISBN: 9780323880626)

**OR**

Sorrentino's Canadian Textbook for the Support Worker Elsevier eBook on VitalSource, 5th Cdn. (Purchase on the Evolve site. The ISBN is: 9780323711661)

Canadian Clinical Skills: Skills for Personal Support Workers, 1st Cdn Edition by Elsevier

Additional learning resources may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

## ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Bow Valley College is licensed to deliver this course as part of the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum 2019.

Additional References:

Alberta Government. (2018). Alberta Health Care Aide Competency Profile. Retrieved on November 10, 2021 from https://open.alberta.ca/dataset/e1fbd562-1571-40b8-bc17-71687dab444c/resource/9e34d246-c389-4753-bda4-f53a77e02f80/download/ah-hca-core-competency-profile-2018.pdf

Alberta Government. (2009*). Freedom of information and protection of privacy: Guidelines and practices*. Retrieved on November 10, 2021 from

http://www.servicealberta.ca/foip/resources/guidelines-and-practices.cfm

Alberta Government. (2019). Health Information Act (HIA). Retrieved on November 10, 2021 from http://www.albertanetcare.ca/learningcentre/Health-Information-Act.htm

Alberta Netcare. (2021). Privacy & Security Quick Reference: Roles & responsibilities in Alberta Netcare. Retrieved on November 10, 2021 from https://www.albertanetcare.ca/PrivacySecurity.htm

Alzheimer Society. (2017, November). Person centred language guidelines. Retrieved November 10, 2021, from https://alzheimer.ca/sites/default/files/documents/Person-centred-language-guidelines_Alzheimer-Society.pdf

Alzheimer Society. (2018, September). Communication: Day to day series. Retrieved November 10, 2021, from https://alzheimer.ca/sites/default/files/documents/day-to-day-series_communication.pdf

Apedaile, S. (2015). The something's up! cycle. NorQuest College. Retrieved on November 10, 2021 from https://www.norquest.ca/NorquestCollege/media/pdf/centres/intercultural/CI/The-Somethings-Up-Cycle-Handout-Apr-2018.pdf

Benedict, C. (2021). *Assertiveness and the four styles of communication*. Retrieved on November 10, 2021, from http://serenityonlinetherapy.com/assertiveness.htm

Berger. L. [Lauren Bergen]. (2016, October 10). *How to write a professional email! The intern queen*. [Video]. YouTube. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zArN4VffMw4

Burgess, H. (2017). *Misunderstandings*. Retrieved on November 10, 2021, from https://www.beyondintractability.org/essay/misunderstandings

CBC. (2021). *8th Fire: Wab's walk through history*. Retrieved November 22, 2021, from https://www.cbc.ca/firsthand/m_blog/8th-fire-wabs-walk-through-history

College of Licensed Practical Nurses. (2020, January 9). Policy: Documentation. Retrieved November 10, 2021, from https://www.clpna.com/wp-content/uploads/2018/04/doc_Policy_Documentation.pdf

College of Licensed Practical Nurses. (2018, April 10). Best practices for quality nursing documentation: policy. Retrieved November 10, 2021, from https://www.clpna.com/2018/04/best-practices-for-quality-nursing-documentation-policy/

College of Speech and Hearing Therapists of British Columbia. (2011). Where's the line? Professional boundaries in a therapeutic relationship. Retrieved on Nov 20, 2021, from https://board.cshbc.ca/docs/where_s_the_line_-_professional_boundaries.pdf

College of Licenced Practical Nurses of Alberta. (2021). Maintaining professional boundaries between nurse and patient: practice guideline. Retrieved November 20, 2021 from https://www.clpna.com/2019/07/maintaining-professional-boundaries-between-nurse-and-patient-practice-guideline/

Diversity Nursing.com. (2018, April 26). *Culturally competent care for LGBTQ patients*. Retrieved on November 10, 2021, from http://blog.diversitynursing.com/blog/culturally-competent-care-for-lgbtq-patients

Griwkowsky, F. (2018, May 10). Homes: A Refugee Story details a Syrian childhood of peril, flight and hope. Edmonton Journal. Retrieved November 10, 2021, from https://edmontonjournal.com/entertainment/books/homes-a-refugee-story-details-a-syrian-childhood-of-peril-flight-and-hope

Government of Alberta. (2013). Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 3 Module 1: Communication and Documentation in the Health-Care Environment. Edmonton, AB

Kryder, S. (2011). *Tips for effectively delivering feedback*. Retrieved on November 10, 2021 from https://www.umbc.edu/blogs/wellness/Deliver%20Feedback%20Effectively.pdf

NorQuest College. (2021). *Intercultural Resources for Educators/Trainers*. Retrieved on November 10, 2021, from https://www.norquest.ca/research-innovation/colbourne-institute-for-inclusive-leadership/intercultural-resources-for-educators-trainers.aspx

UNHCR Canada. (2021). *Refugees in Canada*. Retrieved November 22, 2021, from https://www.unhcr.ca/in-canada/refugees-in-canada/

University of Kentucky Violence Intervention and Prevention Centre. (n.d.). *The four basic styles of communication*. Retrieved on November, 10, 2021 from https://www.uky.edu/hr/sites/www.uky.edu.hr/files/wellness/images/Conf14_FourCommStyles.pdf

Additional information may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

## ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

Students with documented disabilities (e.g., mental health diagnosis, learning disability, physical disability, etc.) may qualify for classroom and/or exam accommodations. The College can also assist students who may be experiencing difficulties with learning but do not have a formal diagnosis. Students who need academic and exam accommodations based on other protected grounds may also make those requests.
It is the student's responsibility to request academic accommodations. Students are encouraged to contact Accessibility Services as early as possible.

Visit: Learner Success Services- 1st floor south campus
Contact: accessibility@bowvalleycollege.ca or 403-410-1440
BVC Central: Accessibility Services

## INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Bow Valley College is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Students are urged to become familiar with and uphold the following policies: Academic Integrity (500-1-7), Student Code of Conduct (500-1-1), Student Appeals (500-1-12), Attendance (500-1- 10), Grading (500-1-6), Academic Continuance and Graduation (500-1-5), and Electronic Communications (300-2-13).
Audio or video recording of lectures, labs, seminars, or any other teaching and learning environment by

students is allowed only with consent of the instructor as part of an approved accommodation plan. Recorded material is to be used solely for personal study and is not being used or distributed without prior written consent from the instructor.

**Academic Integrity:**

At Bow Valley College, we value academic integrity. This means everyone at the college, including students, faculty, and staff, follow principles that foster ethical and truthful ways of being in their work and studies. The college is committed to integrity being infused in all aspects of work and studies. It is important to act with integrity in everything you do at the college. The values you practice at the college are the same values that will inform and guide your career. If someone breaks from the principles that are in agreement with academic integrity policy, the college is committed to carefully investigating and fairly handling any issues related to academic integrity and academic misconduct.

Academic misconduct is acting in such a way as to give yourself or others an unfair academic advantage or disadvantage. Examples of this can include:

- Plagiarism
- Cheating on tests or exams
- Tampering with or falsifying any grades or documents
- Sharing assignments or exam information with others
- Aiding others in dishonest acts
- Using artificial intelligence in graded work without the explicit consent of the instructor
- Recording anything in the classroom or other instructional area without permission

Breaking from the principles that guide academic integrity can lead to educative interventions and/or punitive measures. It is the student's responsibility to review the Academic Integrity Policy. Please review the following resources:

- Academic Integrity Policy Summary
- Academic Integrity Policy
- Academic Integrity Procedure

**Turnitin:**

Students may be required to submit their course work to Turnitin, a third-party service provider engaged by BVC. Turnitin identifies plagiarism by checking databases of electronic books and articles, archived webpages, and previously submitted student work. Students acknowledge that any course work or essays submitted to Turnitin will be included as source documents in the Turnitin.com reference database, where it will be used solely to detect plagiarism. The terms that apply to a student's use of Turnitin are described on Turnitin.com.

**Online Exam Proctoring:**

Examinations for this course may require proctoring through an online proctoring service. Online proctoring enables online exam taking within a controlled and monitored environment, thereby

enhancing academic integrity. Online proctoring may occur through a variety of methods, including but not limited to:

a. live online proctoring where either the course instructor, a representative of Bow Valley College, or a remote invigilator authenticates identity and observes completion of an exam using specialized software and recordings;
b. automated proctoring where the exam session is recorded and AI (artificial intelligence) analyzed;
c. browser lockdown that limits access to other applications, websites, copying, printing, screen capture and other functions; or
d. a combination of both live/automated proctoring and browser lockdown.

Course instructors will review recordings, analyses, and data obtained through online proctoring for academic integrity infractions. It is the student's responsibility to meet the technical, software, location, and identity verification requirements necessary to enable online proctoring.

Further details of these policies are available in the Academic Calendar and on the Bow Valley College website, https://www.bowvalleycollege.ca/academic-calendar.
Students are encouraged to keep a copy of this course outline for future reference.

**Collection of Personal Information:**

This course, including your image and voice, may be recorded and made available to you and other students taking the course. By attending the class(es) online or in person, you consent to the collection of your personal information. If you do not wish to be recorded, please contact your instructor before starting the course/class to discuss alternative arrangements. You may use the recordings only for educational purposes. You must not copy, share, or use the recordings for any other purpose without the instructor's express permission. Your personal information is collected in accordance with section 4 (c) of the Protection of Privacy Act, Alberta (POPA) to deliver academic programming, support student flexibility, promote universal design for learning principles, and for purposes consistent with the course activities and outcomes. Bow Valley College uses automated systems to generate content and make decisions, recommendations and predictions, and your personal information may be included in these automated systems.
Your personal information will be used and disclosed in accordance with sections 12 and 13 of POPA and protected in accordance with section 10 of POPA. If you have any questions about the collection, use, disclosure or protection of personal information, please contact the Access and Privacy Officer at privacy@bowvalleycollege.ca.